

National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students — Eligibility and Application Guide

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Issued in 2024 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/SCH/2024/018, this eligibility and application guide establishes the arrangements supporting National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students. In scope are Merit Scholarship, Undergraduate, Academic Excellence, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Overview

Issued in support of National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students, this guide translates the framework into practical steps for implementation. It is intended to be read alongside the principal document and any related circulars.

This document accompanies National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students and provides operational detail for Merit Scholarship, Undergraduate. Its purpose is to help those responsible for implementation act correctly, consistently and on time.

To Whom It Applies

Except where expressly stated otherwise, the guidance applies uniformly across Higher Education Department, and institutions should treat it as the reference point for day-to-day decisions on Merit Scholarship.

The guidance applies to all institutions and stakeholders falling within the scope of National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students. Specific requirements vary according to institutional type, size and stage of implementation.

Readiness

Eligible participants should meet the conditions set out in National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students, provide the required information, and comply with the procedural expectations described in this guide.

Sequence of Actions

The recommended sequence is to establish governance, communicate expectations, adopt the required arrangements for Merit Scholarship, verify compliance, and report outcomes through the agreed channel.

1. Report on a regular cycle and act on review findings.
2. Appoint a lead officer and notify Higher Education Department of the designated contact.
3. Conduct an initial readiness review against Merit Scholarship, Undergraduate.
4. Brief governing bodies, staff and relevant stakeholders on the expectations.
5. Apply the arrangements and maintain the required records.

Responsibilities

Clear segregation of duties is encouraged, with institutional leadership providing oversight, the designated office managing administration, and internal controls verifying that practice matches policy.

Procedure

Institutions should maintain a written procedure capturing each step of the process, including eligibility checks, documentation, decision-making and appeals, consistent with the provisions of National Merit Scholarship Scheme for Undergraduate Students.

Reporting

A consolidated reporting cycle will allow Higher Education Department to track performance across the sector and to identify emerging issues requiring guidance or intervention.

Closing Note

The success of this scheme rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Merit Scholarship and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.